

The building of the Ezra. Temple, hindered.

the remnant of their brethren, the Priests and the Levites, and all they that were come out of the captiuitie vnto Jerusalem: and appointed the Levites, from twentie yeeres olde and vppward, to set forward the worke of the house of the LORD.

9 Then stood Ieshua, with his sons and his brethren, Kadmiel and his sonnes, the sonnes of Iudah together, to set forward the workemen in the house of God: the sonnes of Benadad, with their sonnes and their brethren the Levites.

10 And when the builders laide the foundation of the Temple of the LORD, they set the Priests in their apparell with Trumpets, and the Levites the sonnes of Asaph, with Cymbales, to praise the LORD, after the ordinance of David king of Israel.

11 And they sung together by course, in praising, and giuing thanks vnto the LORD; Because hee is good, for his mercy endureth for euer towards Israel. And all the people shouted with a great shout, when they praised the LORD: because the foundation of the house of the LORD was laide.

12 But many of the Priests and Levites, and chiefe of the fathers, who were ancient men, that had seene the first house: when the foundation of this house was laide before their eyes, wept with a loude voice, and many shouted aloude for ioy:

13 So that the people could not discern the noyse of the shout of ioy, from the noyse of the weeping of the people: for the people shouted with a loude shout, and the noyse was heard afarre off.

CHAP. III.

1 The aduersaries, being not accepted in the building of the Temple with the Iewes, endeavour to hinder it. 7 Their Letter to Artaxerxes. 17 The decree of Artaxerxes. 23 The building is hindred.

NOW when the aduersaries of Iudah and Benjamin, heard that the children of the captiuitie builded the Temple vnto the LORD God of Israel:

2 Then they came to Zerubbabel, and to the chiefe of the fathers, and said vnto them, Let vs build with you, for wee seeke your God, as yee doe, and we

doe sacrifice vnto him, since the dayes of Elar-Baddon king of Assur, which brought vs vp hither.

3 But Zerubbabel and Ieshua, and the rest of the chiefe of the fathers of Israel, said vnto them, Pou haue nothing to doe with vs, to build an house vnto our God, but we our selues together will build vnto the LORD God of Israel, as king Cyrus the King of Persia hath commanded vs.

4 Then the people of the land weakened the handes of the people of Iudah, and troubled them in building,

5 And hired counsellors against them, to frustrate their purpose, all the dayes of Cyrus king of Persia, euen vntill the reigne of Darius king of Persia.

6 And in the reigne of Ahasuerus, in the beginning of his reigne, wrote they vnto him an accusation against the inhabitants of Iudah and Jerusalem.

7 And in the dayes of Artaxerxes wrote Bishlam, Mithredath, Tabeel, and the rest of their companions, vnto Artaxerxes king of Persia; and the writing of the letter was written in the Syriac tongue, and interpreted in the Syriac tongue.

8 Rehum the Chancellour, and Shimshai the Scribe, wrote a letter against Jerusalem, to Artaxerxes the king, in this sort:

9 Then wrote Rehum the Chancellour, and Shimshai the Scribe, and the rest of their companions: the Dinaites, the Apharsathites, the Tarpelites, the Apharsites, the Archeuites, the Babylonians, the Susanchites, the Dehamites, and the Elamites,

10 And the rest of the nations whom the great and noble Asnappar brought ouer, and set in the cities of Samaria, and the rest that are on this side the River, and at such a time.

11 This is the copy of the Letter, that they sent vnto him, euen vnto Artaxerxes the king: Thy seruants on this side the River, and at such a time,

12 Be it knowen vnto the king, that the Iewes which came vp from thee to vs, are come vnto Jerusalem, building the rebellious and the bad citie, and haue set vp the walles thereof, and ioyned the foundations.

13 Be it knowen now vnto the king, that if this citie be builded, and the wals set vp againe, then will they not pay tolle, tribute, and custome, and so thou shalt

|| Or, Hodaiah, Chap. 2. 4 C.
† Heb. as one.

* 1. Chro. 6. 21. and chap. 16. 7. 2nd
25. 1.

† Heb. Ahasuerus.

|| Or, in peace.
† Heb. societies.

|| Or, Secretaries.

† Chald. societies.

† Chald. Cheneth.

† Hebr. the sonnes of the transporthers.

|| Or, finished
† Chald. founded together.

† Chald. giveth.